

4.3 Prebuilt Archetype Matrices

4.3.1 Archetype Identification Self-Assessment

Answer the three questions below to identify which archetype template sits closest to your character. Use it as a starting scaffold, then adapt with your own Chapter 3 data.

1. When your character is hurt, do they:

- ☐ Go quiet, monosyllabic, and physically withdraw → **Grumpy Hero** lean
- ☐ Talk more, overexplain, fill the silence with words → **Sunshine Heroine** lean
- ☐ Maintain composure, deflect with wit, reveal nothing → **Morally Grey** lean

2. When your character wants something, do they:

- ☐ Minimize the ask, make it sound like no effort, apologize for needing it → **Grumpy Hero** lean
- ☐ Ask warmly but check three times whether it's okay to ask → **Sunshine Heroine** lean
- ☐ State the want as a fact, without asking permission → **Morally Grey** lean

3. When your character is in a room full of people, their speech:

- ☐ Shortens. They exit conversations early. They deflect with directives → **Grumpy Hero** lean
- ☐ Lengthens. They ask questions. They make everyone feel included → **Sunshine Heroine** lean
- ☐ Becomes measured. They wait. They respond with one precise line → **Morally Grey** lean

Whichever column you checked most often is your starting template.

4.3.2 The Three Archetype Templates

The Grumpy Hero

Field	Constraint Statements
Cadence Signature	Fragments of two to four words alternating with one controlled sentence of twelve to fifteen words.
Vocabulary Ceiling	Monosyllabic, blunt, Anglo-Saxon roots. No intensifiers.
Sentence Architecture	High variance. Fragments to controlled statements. Trails off under vulnerability.

Field	Constraint Statements
Emotional Default	Cold, controlled. One microleak of vulnerability per exchange, immediately suppressed.
Conversational Rhythm	Interrupts. Deflects. Exits via directive or subject change.
Signature Tics	Contractions only. Never says "I feel." Ends uncertain statements as questions. Uses "fine" as a conversation-terminator.

The Sunshine Heroine

Field	Constraint Statements
Cadence Signature	Accelerating run-on sentences that build momentum. Three questions before one answer.
Vocabulary Ceiling	Effusive, intensifier-heavy, colloquial. Reaches for metaphor.
Sentence Architecture	Long compound sentences that stack clauses. High variance. Rarely fragments.
Emotional Default	Warm, open, high expressiveness. Anxiety leaking through overexplanation.
Conversational Rhythm	Fills silence. Asks before answering. Agrees verbally while deflecting emotionally.
Signature Tics	Uses "okay so" as a reset phrase. Stacks qualifiers ("really, truly, genuinely"). Trails into laughter when uncomfortable.

The Morally Grey Love Interest

Field	Constraint Statements
Cadence Signature	Measured, deliberate pacing. Each sentence fully formed before the next begins.
Vocabulary Ceiling	Precise, slightly formal. No slang. Occasional cutting wit.
Sentence Architecture	Uniform length. Controlled. No fragments. No trailing.
Emotional Default	Cool amusement masking calculation. One flash of genuine feeling per chapter.
Conversational Rhythm	Waits. Lets the other speaker fill silence. Responds with a single precise line.
Signature Tics	Uses the other character's name in address. Never asks questions (makes statements that function as questions). Uses "interesting" as

Field	Constraint Statements
	a deflection.

4.3.3 Archetype Adaptation Template and Confirmation

Starting Archetype: [GRUMPY_HERO / SUNSHINE_HEROINE / MORALLY_GREY]

My Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Field	Archetype Default (copy from above)	My Character's Version (swap in your Chapte
Cadence Signature	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_CADENCE
Vocabulary Ceiling	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_VOCABUL
Sentence Architecture	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_SENTENC
Emotional Default	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_EMOTION.
Conversational Rhythm	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_RHYTHM_
Signature Tics	[COPY_THE_DEFAULT]	[YOUR_CHARACTER'S_SPECIFIC_TICS]

Adaptation Confirmation Checklist:

- ☐ Every field contains language specific to my character, not generic archetype language.
- ☐ I can read the completed matrix aloud and hear my character's voice, not the archetype's voice.
- ☐ At least two fields differ meaningfully from the archetype default.
- ☐ The Signature Tics contain at least one detail that only my character would do.
- ☐ I have saved the adapted matrix as "[CHARACTER_NAME] — Dialogue Matrix — v1.0 — [DATE]."